there were no prisoners of this sort. The principal reason of it is, the great care that is taken to give children, even the poorest, a moral and religious education. Another thing which contributes to the same intention, is the laudable policy of speedy justice. A criminal has notice of his death, not the manner of it, but a short time before he is to suffer: and he is then indulged with his choice of food, wine, etc. Women are not hanged, but beheaded. Every new executioner has a new sword; and in the arsenal at Bern I saw several old ones hung up in order. In the houses of correction, many of the prisoners were women; whom I saw at work.

The most numerous prisoners are the galley-slaves; improperly so-called, for there are no galleys belonging to Switzerland: though some few are sent to Marseilles.

LAUSANNE. At Lausanne I visited the prison, in which there were at that time no prisoners. There were dungeons; but on entering each of them, the keeper observed, that we were not yet upon the ground, but there were cellars underneath. On conversing with Dr. Tissot, he expressed his surprise at our gaol-distemper; said, "I should not find it in Switzerland": and added, that "he had not heard of its being anywhere but in England." When I mentioned the late Act of Parliament for preserving the health of our prisoners, he approved of it highly, especially the clause which required whitewashing the rooms, and keeping them clean. I did not (as the doctor said) find the gaol-fever in Switzerland.

BERN. I revisited all the prisons at Bern, but here also I found none confined except in the two houses of correction. One of these houses is for citizens, in which the men and women were spinning, for they never work abroad.

In the other (the Schallenhaus) there were, in 1776, one hundred and twenty-four slaves; and in 1778, one hundred and forty-one. They have not each a room to themselves; but there is some distinction of the more and less criminal, both in their rooms and work.[1] The women's wards are totally separate from those of the men. Most of the men are employed in

[1] An old keeper having left the door of one of the men's wards unlocked, twelve prisoners forced the outer door and walked off; the people who happened to see them, suffering them to pass, because they supposed they were going to work in the streets. When four or five of them some time after were retaken and carried to their old lodgings, the magistrates ordered that they should *not be punished*, considering that every one must be desirous of regaining liberty. As they had not been guilty of assault or violence in making their escape, the punishment fell on the keeper for his negligence.

cleaning and watering the streets, and public walks; removing the rubbish of buildings; and the snow and ice in winter. The city is one of the cleanest I have seen. Four or five are chained to a small wagon, and draw; others, more at liberty, sweep, load, etc. The convicts are known by an iron collar, with a hook projecting above their heads: weight about five pounds: I saw one riveted on a criminal in about two minutes. They work in summer from seven to eleven, and from one to six; in winter from eight to eleven, and from one to four. I asked the men, "whether they would choose to work so, or be confined within doors?" "Much rather," they said, "work thus." The less criminal are in separate wards: these work within doors, spinning, etc., in a large room; and have not the iron collar.[1] Fifteen I was sorry to see miserable for want of employment.[2] The prison is not commodious, nor kept very clean. The daily allowance, two pounds of bread; and twice a day a pint and a half of soup, made of barley, beans, etc., which they fetch from the great hospital. In their leisure hours they make and mend shoes, make straw hats, etc., and deliver them as they pass on at work. They are not suffered to practise gaming of any sort. Indeed this is forbidden to all the common people; as playing for any considerable sum is to those of higher rank. The keeper and turnkey are to see that the prisoners perform their devotions every morning and evening. The chaplains pray with them and instruct them on Sunday and Thursday. Once a month other clergymen superintend the service. No visitant admitted on Sunday. Thus a principal object here is to make them better men.

BASIL. At Basil, the gaol for felons is in one of the towers. No prisoners; but many rooms ready with clean straw and blankets. Each prisoner (they said) has a room to himself, in which he is constantly shut up, except when conducted to the council-chamber for examination. One of the strongest cells is in a room by the great clock, and is about six feet high: the (trap) door is in the flat roof. the prisoner goes down by a ladder, which is then taken up: his victuals are put in at a wicket on one side. When I was in the room, and took notice of the

[1] I saw them bring in their week's work, and (after it was examined) receive twenty-seven pounds of flax for the following week. At that time some of the townspeople purchased the flax that had been spun, and paid for it to an inspector who lives near the prison.

[2] Some employment is absolutely necessary; and therefore, where the crimes are of such a nature as to allow or require indulgence, it should be given them by a shorter term of confinement, or in some other way. I have seen this false indulgence to prisoners in several places.